

Nicholas Kimball

FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER

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SUMMARY

Customer-facing engineer who takes end-to-end ownership of technical projects, from requirements and prototyping through production and support. I build and deploy LLM-powered systems myself, and I bring deep enterprise-integration experience across ERPs, TMS, APIs, and messy legacy data. I partner directly with customers to understand their workflows and ship working solutions in fast-paced, ambiguous settings. Comfortable being the technical voice with customers and the person who owns delivery from first conversation to production.

SELECTED PROJECT: AGENTIC LLM WORKFLOW (DEPLOYED)

- Designed and deployed an agentic LLM workflow (Python, Anthropic API with tool calling) that ingests activity data from the Strava API, analyzes it against a structured plan, and delivers automated coaching reports, running unattended on a cloud VM (AWS) via cron.
- Built an eval / observability layer (SQLite run log, LLM-as-judge scoring rubric, prompt versioning) that makes prompt and model changes measurable, plus a benchmark comparing model quality against token cost and latency, using a fixed judge model and awareness of eval noise and judge-independence pitfalls.
- Architected provider-agnostic and data-source-agnostic seams, so swapping the LLM vendor or the data input requires a single adapter and no business-logic changes; separated deterministic computation from model judgment to eliminate a class of LLM factual errors.
- Handled OAuth token lifecycle, secrets hygiene, and privacy (git-ignored sensitive data, scrubbed history, sanitized public templates), production-minded from the start.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Integration Engineer, ProShip · Apr 2024 to Present

Enterprise shipping & logistics software · Remote

- Lead end-to-end delivery of enterprise integrations: requirements and scoping with customers, prototyping, building integrations against their ERP, TMS/WMS, and carrier systems, deployment, cutover, and production support.
- Own the customer relationship and the code across 75+ environments, no two alike; resolve 92% of issues without escalation to engineering by tracing source code to root cause.
- Architected a production integration handling ~1M API requests/day at peak, multi-server / multi-threaded, sub-2-second results across up to 6 carriers.
- Partner with sales and stakeholders to gather requirements, present system designs, and communicate progress and risk to technical and non-technical audiences; codify reusable delivery playbooks.
- Delivered a high-visibility integration on time and under budget; drove 45% of accounts to return for repeat work, including a flagship account spanning 20+ engagements; ramped onto an unfamiliar product and shipped 5 migrations under budget.

Software Quality Engineer, Cognizant Technology Solutions · Jan 2021 to Apr 2023

Remote

- Built automated regression suites for a real-time data-ingestion pipeline, saving 50+ hours of manual coverage biweekly; delivered 15+ releases with zero critical production issues.

SKILLS

LLM & Agentic: Building & deploying LLM systems, agentic design with tool use, LLM-as-judge evaluation, model benchmarking, prompt versioning, deterministic-vs-judgment separation, Anthropic API

Building & Integration: End-to-end delivery, enterprise integrations (ERP, TMS, CRM-style tools), REST/SOAP APIs, OAuth, data pipelines, system design, production support

Languages & Data: Python, Java, C#, JavaScript, SQL, SQLite, Bash, XML, JSON, HTML, CSS

Platforms: AWS, Git, Spring, Maven, MariaDB / SQL Server, Jira, Confluence

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science, University of Wisconsin-Madison · Dec 2019